
THINGS I HAVE BOUGHT FOR PEOPLE WHO ARE ABOUT TO DUMP ME

I have a history of buying expensive gifts for people I feel are about to dump me. It's a terrible plan. If I get a whiff that the person might be on their way out the door, I try to delay this by paying for something that will force that person to stay—for example:

Tickets to a Ratatat concert that I later had to sell on Craigslist when the dude dumped me anyway

A plane ticket from NYC to a wedding in Georgia at which the person dumped me (you knew about this one already, but that doesn't make it less hurtful!)

A \$400 watch (my sole comfort is that this person continues to think of me while wearing it)

A custom necklace with the girl's cats' names on it (though to be fair, I broke up with her *after* I bought her that; guilt is just as motivating as panic for overspending on a dying relationship)

A new winter coat from Betsey Johnson (we were breaking up, sure, but I didn't want her to freeze to death!)

You can't stave off a breakup with money unless you are a billionaire Scientologist and your wife is trapped in a harrowing financial arrangement with you.
